

Research: Titles and Abstracts

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1. **Disclosing Agent Ownership Interest: Variation in Transparency Across MLS Platforms (with Ross,A and Waller,B)**

Disclosure of agent ownership interest is nearly universal in licensing and ethics rules, but implementation clarity may vary considerably across MLS platforms. The idea is to audit how agent-interest disclosures are structured, labeled, and made searchable across multiple MLS systems, treating disclosure quality as a measurable institutional variable rather than a binary legal requirement. Cross-platform comparison would document any gaps between the rule on paper and transparency in practice. The goal is to establish a compliance-and-transparency baseline for subsequent work on whether disclosure clarity affects transaction outcomes.

2. **Diminishing Returns at the Top: School Quality, Price Appreciation, and the Limits of Capitalization (with Waller, B.)**

The capitalization of school quality into house prices is well established; less is known about dynamics. The goal is to test whether price appreciation differs across the school-quality distribution, with particular attention to whether top districts exhibit compressed appreciation because little quality "upside" remains to be priced in. The project would also estimate how long school-performance changes take to appear in prices, whether redistricting can be anticipated and front-run, and how proximity to private schools interacts with public-school capitalization. The intended contribution is a dynamic, nonlinear view of school-quality capitalization beyond the static premium.

3. **The Cost of Affordability: Simulating Lifetime Earnings Losses from Housing Cost-Burden Preservation**

The idea is to use a lifecycle simulation of two agents to examine whether preserving a target housing cost-to-income ratio under means-tested housing subsidies can induce forgone earnings, and if so, how large those losses might be. Agents face a trade-off between short-run affordability (keeping rent burden low via subsidy eligibility) and long-run income growth. The central question is whether rational or quasi-rational decisions to suppress earnings growth in order to remain under subsidy-relevant burden thresholds could compound into substantial lifetime earnings losses. The simulation would isolate housing cost-burden preservation as the decision rule and trace its cumulative effects on wages, human capital accumulation, and lifetime income trajectories.

4. **The Hidden Cost of Income Limits: A Welfare Comparison of Housing Subsidy Designs**

The idea is to compare the deadweight loss of two dominant housing subsidy designs, flat subsidized rent below an income threshold and rent as a percent of income below a threshold, against an uncapped

percent-of-income alternative. Using standard public-finance tools for notches and kinks, the analysis would examine whether income caps create extensive-margin distortions and bunching at eligibility boundaries, and whether an uncapped percent-of-income schedule, by removing the cliff, performs better on welfare grounds than either capped program. The framework would then add mobility frictions to assess whether they lock households into suboptimal locations near binding thresholds and how they alter the welfare comparison. A final analysis would examine behavioral responses as incomes approach program limits.

5. Degree of Overpricing, Buyer Arrivals, and Time-on-Market: A Simultaneous-Equations Approach

The idea is to reexamine the joint determination of pricing and marketing time equations. Literature to date has treated degree of overpricing (DOP), buyer arrivals, and time-on-market (TOM) as simultaneously determined. Rather than treating list price or sale price as exogenous drivers of DOM, the proposed approach would model DOP as the seller's key choice variable and buyer arrivals as an endogenous market response. A simultaneous-equations framework would be used to test how initial overpricing affects arrival intensity and how arrival intensity feeds back into marketing duration and eventual sale outcomes. The goal is to clarify why reduced-form price-DOM estimates often conflict across studies and to develop a structural path from pricing strategy to transaction performance.

6. Estimating Unobservable Buyer Demand: An Inventory-Based Approach

The number of active buyers in a local housing market is almost never directly observed, yet it is central to search, pricing, and time-on-market models. The idea is to develop an inventory-based proxy for market-level buyer demand, building from average days of inventory and related absorption measures. Drawing an analogy to labor-market tightness (vacancy duration versus job seekers), the goal is to construct and validate a measure of buyer-side market depth that could be implemented with standard MLS inventory data. The intended contribution is primarily methodological: a transparent, replicable proxy for an otherwise latent demand stock that could be used in TOM, pricing, and market-condition research.

7. Rethinking the Price-DOM Relationship: Is It Linear After All?

The price-days-on-market literature has long disagreed on sign while largely agreeing on functional form: studies report both positive and negative associations, but almost always under linear specifications. The idea is to revisit that consensus by testing whether the price-DOM relationship is nonlinear. If the true relationship is U-shaped, inverted-U, or regime-dependent, conflicting signs in prior work may reflect different samples of a common nonlinear surface rather than genuine economic disagreement. Using flexible functional forms, the goal is to reassess the shape of the relationship and to draw out implications for pricing strategy and for models that treat price and marketing time as jointly determined.

8. Announcement, Removal, and Market Response: An Event Study of the NAR Commission Settlement

The idea is an event study examining whether the NAR commission settlement affected housing markets at three economically distinct moments: settlement announcement, announcement that MLS cooperating compensation fields would be removed, and actual removal of cooperating fees from MLS systems. The design would separate information effects (announcement windows) from mechanical implementation effects (removal date), and could exploit staggered MLS compliance where timing differs across markets. Outcomes of interest include transaction volume, marketing time, list-to-sale ratios, and commission-related listing practices. The goal is to provide early systematic evidence on whether commission-structure reform was priced into residential markets and when.

9. Homogeneous Versus Heterogeneous Goods: Testing Agent Performance in Condo and Single-Family Transactions

A natural hypothesis is that agent value-added matters more when properties are harder to value. Single-family homes are highly heterogeneous in lot, condition, and finishes, while condos are more standardized and comparable within buildings or complexes. The goal is to test whether agent performance, measured via price, time-on-market, and sale probability relative to hedonic benchmarks, differs systematically between the two property types. A larger and more variable agent effect in the single-family segment would support an information-and-expertise channel; a null difference would suggest that agent effects operate mainly through marketing, networks, or negotiation rather than resolution of property-specific uncertainty.

10. Firing the Agent: Does Switching After Poor Performance Actually Help?

Sellers who experience poor listing outcomes often switch agents, implicitly betting that underperformance reflects agent quality rather than bad luck or adverse market conditions. The idea is to test whether switching after poor performance improves subsequent outcomes, or whether apparent improvement is largely regression to the mean. Linking sequential listings and agent changes in MLS data, the analysis would attempt to separate skill-based gains from mean reversion and market-cycle effects. The analysis would speak to whether sellers can learn about agent quality from noisy performance signals and whether the costly decision to fire the agent systematically pays off.

11. How Agent Markets Form and Evolve: Spatial Concentration, Competitor Entry, and Inventory Shocks in Residential Brokerage

The idea is to study how residential agent markets form and change over space and time. The project would examine spatial concentration of agent activity, entry by competitors, and responses to inventory shocks, treating the local brokerage market as an evolving competitive environment rather than a fixed backdrop. The analysis would link agent geographic footprints and market polygons to entry, exit, and performance dynamics. By documenting whether and how agent markets thicken, thin, and reconfigure, the goal is to provide a market-structure foundation for research on agent value, specialization, and client outcomes.

12. Repricing to Sell: The Effects of List Price Changes on Price, Time-on-Market, and Sale Likelihood

Sellers frequently revise list prices during a marketing spell, yet the effects of repricing on final sale price, remaining time-on-market, and sale probability remain incompletely understood. The idea is to estimate how list-price reductions (and increases) affect transaction outcomes, accounting for endogenous timing of revisions and for information revealed by initial buyer response. The analysis would aim to distinguish strategic price discovery from distress-driven discounting and to quantify trade-offs among price concession, marketing duration, and sale likelihood. The project is intended to inform optimal dynamic pricing strategies for sellers and agents during an active listing.

13. Jack of All Trades or Master of One? Agent Specialization and Client Performance in Residential Brokerage

Residential agents differ sharply in whether they specialize by property type, price segment, geography, or client side (buyer versus seller). The idea is to measure specialization from transaction histories and to test whether specialist agents deliver better client outcomes than generalists. Performance would be evaluated on price, time-on-market, and sale probability, with attention to selection of agents into niches and of clients into agent types. The central question is whether depth of focus (master of one)

outperforms breadth (jack of all trades) in residential brokerage, and whether, and under what market conditions, specialization premiums appear.

14. Seller Timing Decisions Reconsidered: The Listing Date, Not the Sale Date, Drives Outcomes

Much of the seasonality literature treats sale timing as if it were a seller choice. In practice, sellers choose when to list; once listed, buyer arrivals and competing inventory largely determine when a sale occurs. The idea is to reframe seller timing as a listing-date decision and to estimate which listing months maximize price, minimize days on market, and raise sale probability. By separating the controllable decision (list date) from the market-determined outcome (sale date), the goal is to clarify the true margins of seller influence and to revisit seasonal thick-market effects from the correct decision node.

15. Local Expertise or Undiversified Risk? Geographic Concentration and REIT Returns

REIT geographic focus is often framed purely as a diversification choice. The idea is to instead treat concentration, measured at zip, MSA, and CBSA levels using HHI and related metrics, as a potential signal of managerial skill analogous to concentrated "stock picking" in active asset management. The goal is to test whether geographic concentration is associated with excess returns after standard risk controls, and whether any premium is consistent with local information advantages rather than simple undiversified exposure. Multi-scale measurement would allow the concentration performance relationship to vary with spatial granularity, sharpening the skill-versus-risk interpretation.

16. An Unintended Instrument of Exclusion: How Septic-Driven Lot Minimums Caused Residential Segregation

Private septic systems require larger lots for leach fields and setbacks, creating an engineering rationale for large-lot development that may produce exclusionary demographic outcomes without explicit discriminatory zoning language. The goal is to test whether septic-driven lot minimums increased residential segregation as an unintended consequence of an ostensibly neutral infrastructure standard, and to seek causal evidence on that channel. Identification would need to separate infrastructure constraints from municipal preferences over density and composition, and to document demographic sorting along the public-sewer versus private-septic margin. The aim is to assess whether a technologically mediated channel of exclusion belongs in the land-use and segregation literature.

17. The Relationship Between Rental Housing Share and Neighborhood Characteristics

The idea is to examine associations between rental housing concentration and neighborhood characteristics across school performance, demographic composition, and income distribution. At an early stage, the analysis would be intentionally descriptive: documenting patterns linking tenure mix to local community attributes without asserting a settled causal hierarchy. The analysis would be positioned against the homeownership-externality and neighborhood-effects literatures, with attention to composition versus change over time. The goal is to provide a baseline map of how rental share co-varies with schools, demographics, and income, and to clarify where stronger identification will be needed for causal claims.

18. Are Neighborhoods Always Local? Redefining Housing Market Competition Beyond Distance

Housing research typically defines competitive sets by distance (e.g., within one mile) or administrative boundaries. The idea is to ask whether multidimensional similarity, property attributes, amenity access, local demographics, school quality, and property taxes, better defines the relevant market than physical

proximity alone. The project would construct characteristics-based competitor sets and compare them with distance-based definitions in predicting price co-movement and competitive outcomes. If similarity dominates distance, standard practices for comps, hedonics, and "local market" fixed effects may systematically mismeasure substitution and competition.

19. Natural Disasters as Catalysts for Redevelopment

Natural disasters destroy capital stock but may also lower redevelopment costs, unlock emergency rezoning and public support, and compress approval timelines relative to non-disaster counterfactuals. The idea is an exploratory study assessing whether disasters act as catalysts for redevelopment through cost, regulatory, and speed channels. Because clean counterfactuals are difficult, the analysis would emphasize descriptive and quasi-experimental designs around disaster declarations, recovery programs, and permitting outcomes. The intended contribution is a structured evaluation of whether, when, and through which mechanisms destruction coincides with accelerated rebuilding and land-use change.